

VERGILIUS

VERGILIAN BIBLIOGRAPHY 1963-4

Author(s): Alexander G. McKay

Source: *Vergilius* (1959-), 1964, No. 10 (1964), pp. 40-44

Published by: The Vergilian Society

Stable URL: <https://www.jstor.org/stable/41591593>

JSTOR is a not-for-profit service that helps scholars, researchers, and students discover, use, and build upon a wide range of content in a trusted digital archive. We use information technology and tools to increase productivity and facilitate new forms of scholarship. For more information about JSTOR, please contact support@jstor.org.

Your use of the JSTOR archive indicates your acceptance of the Terms & Conditions of Use, available at <https://about.jstor.org/terms>



The Vergilian Society is collaborating with JSTOR to digitize, preserve and extend access to *Vergilius* (1959-)

JSTOR

VERGILIAN BIBLIOGRAPHY 1963-4.

ECLOGUES AND GEORGICS:

BROOKS Otis in his recent Virgil: A Study in Civilized Poetry (Oxford, 1963) examines the style of the Eclogues, matters of structure, points where Vergil deviates markedly from Theocritus and the Neoterics, and the larger and infinitely more complicated matter of arrangement of the Eclogue Book. The Georgics undergo similar fresh examination and equally arresting ideas emerge on their composition, their organic nature, persistent symbols, and the contrast of books. Otis has blazed bright new paths for further research into both works. Two interesting articles appeared in Acta Classica (proceedings of the Classical Association of South Africa 5 (publ., 1963): E. E. Beyers' "Virgil's Seventh Eclogue--A Theory of Poetry" (38-47), and G. Cipolla's "Political Audacity and Esotericism in the Ninth Eclogue" (48-57). C. Day Lewis has provided a new translation--The Eclogues and Georgics of Virgil (Doubleday Anchor Original, A 390) with the Latin text. The translation of the Georgics was published in 1947. Both versions demonstrate the undoubted poetic affinity which Day Lewis has for Vergil's poetic art and craft. His sympathetic and lyrical treatment of the poetry emerges sharply and engagingly in a Westminster Spoken Arts Long Playing Record 733 (issued in 1956) featuring C. Day Lewis reading from his translation of the Georgics. H. H. Huxley offers a new teaching edition entitled Virgil: Georgics i and iv (Methuen, 1963) with vocabulary and notes.

AENEID

Absolutely indispensable for its comprehensive nature and brave hypotheses is Brooks Otis' Virgil: A study in Civilized Poetry. Otis finds novelty of style and method in Vergil's epic. He emphasizes the importance of Eclogues and Georgics in the formative development of Vergil's poetic craft and ideas, and argues persuasively for the poet's contemporary purpose and triumphant success with the ancient form and narrative content. A full scale review of this important work will appear in the next issue of Vergilius. P. McGushin's "Virgil and the Spirit

of Endurance", AJP 85 (1964) 225-53 emphasizes the burden (moles) of Rome's greatness, and the endurance and strain and labor it involves for Aeneas and Augustus. The Atlas-Hercules symbolism, implicit in Aeneas' epic career, provides insight into the meaning of Aeneas' role in Rome's story. L. A. MacKay's "The Aeneid as Anti-Epic," CW 57 (1963-64) 94 (abstract) examines unconventional aspects of the Aeneid in intention and attitude, and in the tension between Vergil's emotional involvement and detached irony towards his hero and Rome's epic. Horace's verdict on Vergil's genius, molle atque facetum, "sentimental and sophisticated," provides nice insight into an epic where conventional values are inverted and where the Homeric epics are parodied seriously in the general theme and separate episodes. The Trojan War, in Troyland and Italy, is Civil War; the battles are depressing, the hero often in a quandary, a conscripted man in a "war-novel" where morality, human and divine, is questionable. Wendell Clausen's short lecture, "An Interpretation of the Aeneid," Harvard Studies in Classical Philology 68 (1964) 139-47, lays emphasis on the Aeneid as instinct with Roman sensibility, as the most complete expression of the meaning of Rome. The melancholy hero and the larger structure of the poem which enlists sympathy on the side of loneliness, suffering, and defeat are examined to determine how Vergil values the achievement of Rome. J. B. Garstang's article, "Aeneas and the Sibyls," CJ 59 (1963) 97-101, finds correspondence between the locations of the Mediterranean Sibyls and Aeneas' landfalls. Only Lydia is excluded from Vergil's catalogue, perhaps because of the Etruscan association with Lydia (Herodotus, 1, 94); and only the Cumaeen Sibyl is named. Garstang senses a blend of several Sibyls in Deiphobe, the somewhat querulous ministrant and guide to the Pilgrim Father of antiquity. R. D. Williams takes a fresh look at "Virgil and the Odyssey" in Phoenix 17 (1963) 266-74, an article which should be required reading in schools and colleges. Vinzenz Buchheit's monograph, Vergil über die Sendung Roms. Untersuchungen zum Bellum Poenicum und zur Aeneis (Heidelberg, 1963) compares and interprets Aeneid 1 and 7, and examines several instances of Vergil's creative borrowing from the Greeks, and from Naevius and Ennius (Bellum Punicum, 1-3.) Buchheit conceives an architectural, triple arch design for the Aeneid extending from start to finish and involving the figure of Juno, hostile to Aeneas' (and Rome's) mission, the Return of the Native Son, descendant of Italian Dardanus and ancestor of Italian Augustus, and thirdly, the Rome-Carthage confrontation and conflict. B. Farrington discusses "Polemical Allusions to the De rerum Natura of Lucretius in the works of Virgil" in

GERAS: Studies presented to George Thomson on the occasion of his 60th birthday (Charles University, Prague, 1963.) Although Vergil appears to have been sensitive to Lucretius as poet, he criticises his Epicurean ideas and the way of life by means of polemical allusions, particularly in the characterization of Dido but in several other important areas as well. Kenneth Quinn's Latin Explorations: Critical Studies in Roman Literature (London, 1963) contains two essays on Vergilian topics: "Virgil's Tragic Queen" (29-58), and "The Tempo of Virgilian Epic" (198-238.) Quinn's theories and interpretations are always independent and thought-provoking. He vindicates Aeneid 4 as a tragedy wherein Aeneas progresses, through suffering and the knowledge of the immensity of his mission, to a new level as epic hero. No longer the individualistic Homeric warrior, he moves towards a new role as servant of Rome's destiny, and the sacrifice of Dido is part of the tragic progression. Quinn tries to redress the balance of sympathy in Book 4 and says, at one point in his discussion: "Those who think ill of Aeneas for deserting Dido are often the same people who think ill of Mark Antony for not deserting Cleopatra." The chapter on the tempo of the epic provides a useful and instructive analysis of an intriguing subject.

On matters large and small which pertain to the separate books there has been noteworthy research particularly into Books 2 and 6 in the first half, and enlarging awareness of the importance and integrity of the second half of the epic as a whole. Richard T. Bruère's note on "The Helen Episode in Aeneid 2 and Lucan" CP 59 (1964) 267, comments on R. G. Austin's useful article "Virgil, Aeneid 2. 567-88" CQ 11 (1961) 185-98. Austin regards the Helen episode as authentically Vergilian, but feels, too, that Plotius and Tucca excluded the lines from their authoritative text. When they were inserted, the episode remained somewhat detached from its context. But Bruère shows convincingly that the lines were echoed repeatedly by Lucan in Bellum Civile 10. Lucan evidently knew the passage in its present context and was sufficiently impressed by it to echo the diction frequently in somewhat analogous circumstances. John H. D'Arms offers exegesis for "Vergil's cunctantem (ramum): Aeneid 6, 211" in CJ 59 (1964) 265-8. Servius challenged the meaning "resisting" as contradictory (cf. 6, 146-7) and aligned its meaning with the pliancy and weight of the golden bough. D'Arms argues that the participle, with the noun omitted, implies personification of the bough, not all wooden and metallic, but mysteriously animate also. The golden bough yields to Aeneas' violence with something approximating regret: cunctantem implies "lingering" or "reluctantly" with

sympathetic overtones on Vergil's part to its lovely, fragile nature as talisman for Aeneas in Hades.

Francis R. Bliss in a learned paper entitled "Aeneas and Empedocles: The Fugitive Soul," connects Aeneas' career, fato profugus, with Empedocles' version of Orphic eschatology. Empedocles' mystical identification of himself as a fugitive, wandering from god, a representative human soul in exile, is regarded as inspirational in Vergil's conception of Aeneas. Particularly in Book 6, but elsewhere as well, Aeneas is conceived of as a dynamic hero, a soul progressing through a graded universe, a process whereby Aeneas' character develops and is refined. Michael Wigodsky's paper, "The arming of Aeneas," CW 57 (1963-64) 95 (abstract) argues that both Trojan and Latin have claims to be successors to the Greek victors at Troy. Achilles shimmers through both Turnus and Aeneas. Vergil's Hellenization of his Trojans, after his initial hostility (particularly in Aeneid 2) is noteworthy. Wigodsky feels that the Greeks are exemplars of brutality and savagery in war, representatives of primitive society and of an instinct (furor) to which even Aeneas must occasionally succumb. Fire imagery, regularly associated with demonic powers, is eventually assigned to Aeneas himself, his encounters (with Cacus) and the shield. Aeneas' tragedy appears to lie in the necessity to assume Greek ruthlessness to conquer the forces or chaos, and to establish an ordered civilization. Leslie A. Field discovers four controlling images in Aeneid 7 and 8 in his semi-popular article "The Vergil-Lewis Aeneid as Literature", Bucknell Review 11. 1 (1962) 81-94. Field regards these two books as basic ingredients in the education of Aeneas. Life is viewed in terms of fertility, productivity and peacefulness, with the complementary background and necessity of death, disorder and war.

Dido's tragedy is paralleled in part at least by the sympathetic and tragic study of Evander in Books 8, 10, and 11. G. R. Manton's "Virgil and the Greek Epic: The Tragedy of Evander" AUMLA 17 (1962) 5-17, argues that the Iliad and Aethiopis helped greatly to shape the second half of the Aeneid. Camilla's exploits, and the self-sacrifice of Lausus for his father Mezentius, are among Vergil's creative and adaptive borrowings. But the tragedy of Evander, with its reminiscence of Pylian Nestor, is a major indebtedness on Vergil's part. The tragedy ends only when Pallas is avenged in the last lines of Book 12.

Worthy of special notice is Henry W. Prescott's "The Development of Virgil's Art", originally published in 1927, now available in a reprint by Russell and Russell, New York (1963). For cautious good sense, organization and lucidity, Prescott's study remains generally authoritative

within its limitations, an attractive thought-provoking study before the complicated refinements of symbolism and golden section in Vergilian studies. Margaret R. Scherer's The Legends of Troy in Art and Literature, (Phaidon Press, 1963), offers marvellous illustrations to students of the Aeneid, a superb historical and partly analytical account of Troy's place in European art and letters. Janette Richardson's "Virgil and Milton once again" appears in Comparative Literature 14 (1962) 321-31.

TEXTS AND TRANSLATIONS

Several useful teaching editions of the Aeneid have appeared during the past year, most notably R. G. Austin's exemplary P. Vergili Maronis Aeneidos Liber Secundus (Oxford, 1964) with a commentary which combines scholarship on every level of interpretation, with brilliant hypotheses and exciting sensitivity to the poetic design and craft. Less exhaustive but attractively and carefully produced are: Clyde Pharr's Vergil's Aeneid: Books I - VI, with introduction, notes, vocabulary, and grammatical appendix (Revised) (Boston, 1964), and H. E. Gould's Vergil: Aeneid Book xi, edited with introduction, notes, and vocabulary (Macmillan, 1964.) Yet another translation of the Aeneid appeared during the past year: James H. Martinband's Vergil, The Aeneid, (New York, 1964) with an introduction. Recent translations will claim their proper due in a review article slated for the next issue of Vergilius.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

For splendid coverage see George E. Duckworth, "Recent Work on Vergil" (1957-63) (No. 34 in the Survey Series), in CW 57 (1963-64) 193-228. As a service to members and to the profession the Vergilian Society has prepared a reprint of the survey which is available to members of the Society for 50¢ prepaid, and for 75¢ prepaid to others. Send orders and payments to THE CLASSICAL WORLD, Fordham University, Bronx 58, New York.

COLLECTED ADDRESSES

Joint members of the Vergilian Society of America and the Virgil Society (England) have received the latest issue of the Proceedings of the Virgil Society (No. 3, 1963-4) with enlightening essays by: Michael Grant, "Virgil the European" (1-11); J. H. Moxley, "Virgil and the Silver Latin Epic" (12-26); Miss M. R. Arundel, "Principio caelum (Aeneid vi. 724-51)" (27-34); and K. Wellesley, "Virgil's Homer Revisited" (36-43). A new feature provides book reviews by W. F. Jackson Knight, P. T. Eden, and H. MacL. Currie (44-51). Copies of the English Proceedings may be obtained through the office of the Secretary-Treasurer of the Vergilian Society of America. The Annual Subscription costs \$1.00.

Alexander G. McKay

McMaster University